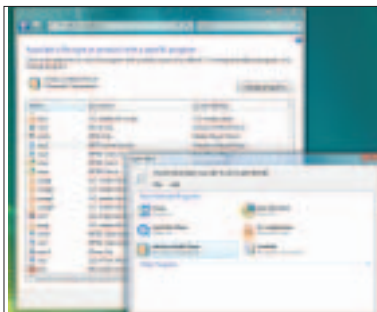


can click the DVD movie list, say, and select Play DVD Movie using Windows Media Player. You'll often have many other actions available, though. Click the Audio CD list, for instance, and you'll find Windows Vista can be set up to automatically rip music from an audio CD as soon as you insert it.

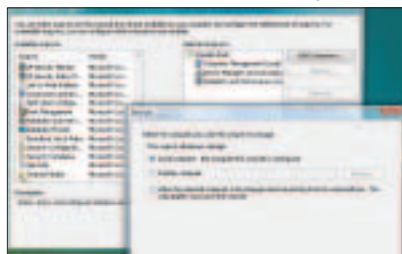
Tip 9

Another Windows Vista change has seen the File Types dialogue box (the place where you'd tell Windows which programs you'd like to use to open a particular file type) relocate from Windows Explorer to the Control Panel. If you want a different application to open when you double-click on MP3 files, for instance, click Programs (or Default Programs) > Associate a file type... to see the new applet. Scroll down the list, clicking on the .mp3 format when you've found it, then click Change program and choose your favourite MP3 player. It's not there? Click Browse and navigate to your chosen program file. Click OK when you're done, try double-clicking an MP3 file and Windows should now launch the application you've just selected.



Tip 10

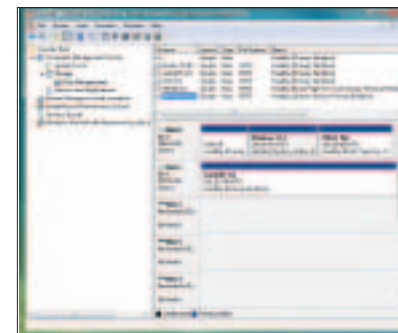
Perhaps the biggest problem with Control Panel is the way all the most useful functionality is spread around several different applets. With just a couple of minutes work you can build your very own custom Control Panel applet that contains only the features you use most often. The tool that will manage all this for you is called the Microsoft Management Console. Click Start, type mmc.exe in the Search box and press [Enter] to launch it, then click File > Add/Remove Snap-in.



Browse the contents of the 'Available snap-ins' box to discover the functionality that your custom applet will be able to include.

Tip 11

Select your favourite applets in the Available snap-ins list, then click Add (click Finish if prompted) to add them to your applet. If you're not sure what to pick, then we'd opt for Computer Management, Device Manager, Disk Management, Event Viewer, Reliability and Performance Monitor, Services and Windows Firewall. Keep the list as short as possible, though, so it's easy to find any particular function. Click OK when you're done. You can then customise the interface if you like, perhaps removing the pointless Actions pane (View > Customize > clear the Action pane box). Click File > Save As to save the applet when you're done, then launch it from Start > All Programs > Administrative Tools, or create a shortcut.



Tip 12

Now let's have a bit of useful fun using a little-known brand new feature of the Control Panel. We're going to show you in two steps how to make the standard system clock that appears on the Taskbar show you the time in three different time zones all at once. First, open Control Panel and click on 'Clock, Language and Region'. Then click on 'Add clocks for different time zones'. Your screen should now look like the one in the picture. Click on

